

as the work of Luis Buñuel) and discuss the impact these references might have on the meaning of the video.

Consider the codes and conventions of media forms and products:

- Ways in which the music video seems to defy or **subvert music video conventions**:
 - » Whilst it is a convention of the music video form to have song **lyrics interpreted** on screen, the overt and deliberate way the lyrics are interpreted in this music video might be subverting this convention:
 - * The opening line “*I was scared of dentists and the dark*” is interpreted explicitly with a shot of a female looking “scared” with a metallic contraption in her mouth that suggests she is in a dentist’s chair and followed by a shot of a light swinging in a darkened room. This **overt graphical representation** of the lyrics is largely repeated throughout the video. Consider whether this is following or subverting the convention of lyrical interpretation.
 - » The music video seems to explicitly reference **feature films**:
 - * The **opening shot** makes use of cinematic style credits and information about the music is presented with a title at the bottom of the screen. This title is graphically similar to a “**billing block**” or “**credit block**” which is often seen on film posters or in trailers. Consider why this style of presentation might have been appropriated from the film genre and how this might frame an audience response. Is the video presenting itself as a short film or a music video?
 - * The video frequently references the Western and Thriller **genres** (and arguably the hipster style of Wes Anderson films), but most notably uses **Horror genre iconography**, e.g. females repeatedly dragged off screen by unseen forces and a character going missing in a dark graveyard.
 - * Consider whether the overt use of **references to film** is attempting to offer an implied artistic value that transcends the music video form.

Consider the significance of challenging and/or subverting genre conventions:

- *Riptide* is relatively **unusual** both as a music video and specifically as a text within the indie folk genre in terms of its style, rejection of narrative and lack of spectacle or special effects.
- Comparison could be made with a later Vance Joy video *Georgia* (2015), which follows many more conventions, to consider why *Riptide* **challenges or subverts** the conventions of the genre.
- Candidates might explore the way in which the video might have been designed to confer a sense of **uniqueness** or intrigue to the band. Consider the **purpose** of music videos and the way that Vance Joy are been marketed to audiences through the style of the video.

Consider theoretical perspectives:

Semiotics – Roland Barthes

- Explore the concept of **signifier/signified** using specific signification in the music video and how this might be interpreted according to social convention, for example the pile of dollar bills which accompanies the line “*Oh, all my friends are turning green*”.
 - » Explore Barthes idea that **constructed meanings can come to seem self-evident** by discussing the connotations of the colour green in relation to both money and envy - this could be said to have achieved Barthes’ status of **myth** through a process of **naturalisation** which might allow for complicated readings of the image.
 - » This example of **polysemy** could be **interpreted** in a variety of ways e.g. is it implying that friends (possibly in other bands) have “sold out” by giving into money? Or might instead these friends be turning green with envy at the success of Vance Joy?

Genre Theory – Steve Neale

- Use the video to explore Neale’s idea that genres may be dominated by **repetition**, but are also marked by **difference, variation, and change**.
- Discuss the ways in which the indie folk music video **genre** is dominated by **repetition** (low-fi videos with bands playing instruments etc.) and the extent to which *Riptide* offers **variation** to these aspects.
- An extension of this discussion might explore the way that the video fits into the wider **economic and institutional context** of the music